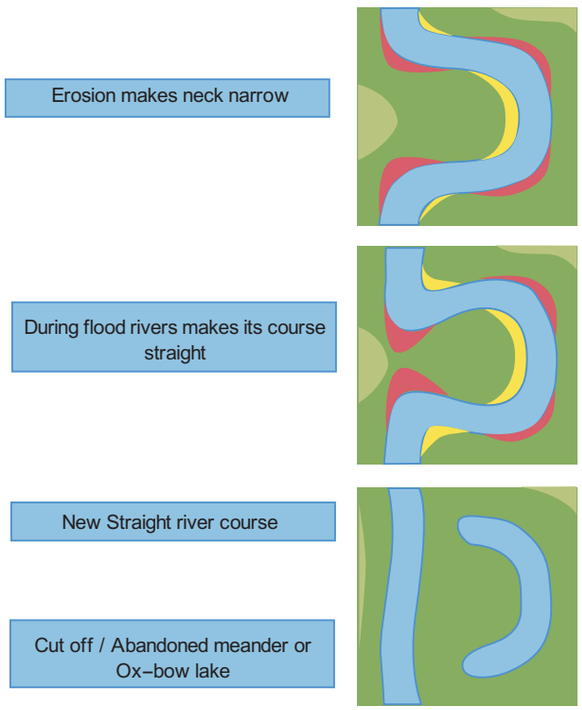
deposition along the sides of the meander, the ends of the meander loops come closer. In due course of time the meander loop cuts off from the river and forms a cut-off lake, also called an ***Ox-bow lake***.



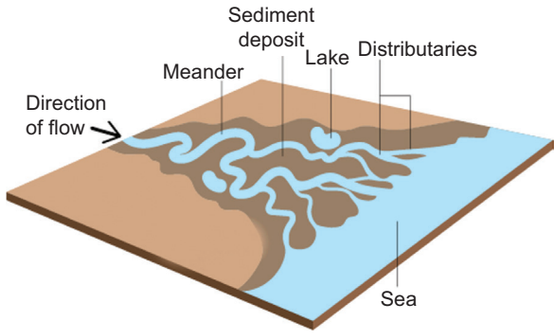
Formation of ox–bow lake



The term **'Meander'** has been named on the basis of Meander River of Asia Minor (Turkey), which flows through numerous curves and turns.

At times the river overflows its banks. This leads to the flooding of the neighbouring areas. As the river floods, it deposits layers of fine soil and other material called ***sediments*** along its banks. This leads to the formation of a flat fertile ***floodplain.*** The raised banks are called ***levees.***

As the river approaches the sea, the speed of the flowing water decreases and the river begins to break up into a number of streams called ***distributaries***. The velocity of the river becomes so slow that it begins to deposit its load. The collection of sediments from all the mouths form ***Delta.*** Deltas are excellent productive lands. E.g. *Cauvery delta, Ganges delta, Mississippi delta.*



Delta

Find out the names of a few rivers of the world that form a delta with the help of the Atlas.

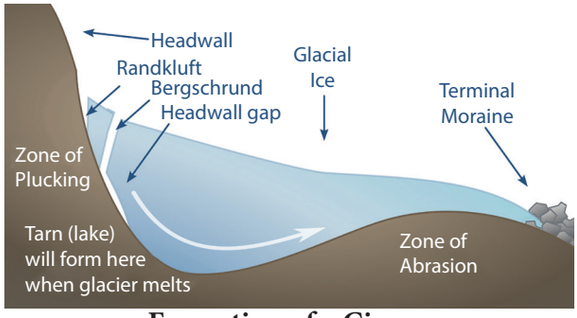
Glacier

A large body of ice moving slowly down a slope or valley due to gravity is called a ***glacier***. Glaciers are grouped into ***Mountain or Valley Glaciers and Continental Glaciers.***

Continental Glacier: The glacier covering vast areas of a continent with thick ice sheets. E.g. *Antarctica, Greenland*

Mountain or Valley Glacier is a stream of ice, flowing along a valley. It usually follows former river courses and are bounded by steep sides. *E.g. The Himalayas and the Alps.*

Glaciers, expose the solid rocks of earth by removing the loose materials found on it.



Formation of a Cirque

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